

IZZAH

THE PATH OF
TRUE HONOR

Teachings of Imam Ali
(peace be upon him)

For young minds seeking
dignity in a fast-moving world

Compiled by
Syed Imon Rizvi

Izzah: The Path of True Honor

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in a fast-moving world***

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2025

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***In the Name of Allah,
the All-beneficent,
the All-merciful.***

1. Foundations: Allah as the Source of Dignity

“Everything is submissive to Him and everything exists through Him; He is wealth for every poor person, dignity for every humiliated one, strength for every weak one, and refuge for every afflicted one.”

Source: Nahj al-Balagha, Sermon 109

2. The Hollow Nature of Honor Apart from God

“Every honor other than God Almighty is humiliation, and every strength other than Him is weakness.”

Source: Nahj al-Balagha,
Sermon 65

3. Honor in Islam and Righteousness

“No honor is higher than Islam, and no dignity is higher than piety/righteousness (taqwa).”

Source: Nahj al-Balagha, Hikmah 371; Al-Kafi 188; Tuhaf al-‘Uqool, p. 67

4. A Hard Look at Worldly Honor

“The honor of this world is humiliation, and its seriousness is a joke.”

Source: Nahj al-Balagha,
Sermon 191

5. Why Chasing Worldly Pride Is a Losing Game

“Do not compete for the honor and pride of this world... because this honor and pride are destined to end.”

Source: Nahj al-Balagha,
Sermon 99

6. Oppression and False Honor: A Moral Cause and Effect

“Whoever seeks honor through oppression and falsehood, Allah will make him inherit humiliation with justice and truth.”

Source: Ibn Abi al-Hadid,
Volume 20, p. 309

7. Independence as a Mark of Dignity

“The honor of a believer is his independence from people.”

Source: Nahj al-Balagha,
Hikmah 113

8. Freeing Yourself from Coveting Others

“Honor is in giving up
hope in what others
possess.”

Source: Ghurar al-Hikam,
Hadith 498/28:1

9. The Highest Honor: Forbearance (Ḥilm)

“ N o h o n o r l i k e
forbearance (ḥilm).”

Source: Dustur Ma'alim al-
Hikam, p. 19; Al-I'jaz wal-Ijaz,
p. 35